



TAMIL NADU LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY

ADDRESS BY
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GOVERNOR OF TAMIL NADU

On 18th June 2026
Aani 4, Thiruvalluvar Aandu-2057

**Hon'ble Members of the Legislative
Assembly,**

Vanakkam.

Perarignar Anna once said, "**The people are the true masters of the nation**". At the very outset, I convey my best regards to the Members of the Legislative Assembly seated here for the first session of the Seventeenth Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, who have been chosen by the people, the real masters of Tamil Nadu, in the recently concluded Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly elections.

2. As Members of this historic Assembly — the very heart and intellect of our democracy — I am confident that you will debate on

people's needs, enact laws accordingly and safeguard the welfare of the people.

3. Annal Ambedkar profoundly stated, **"True democracy is the union of all three — equality, liberty and fraternity"**.

For such a democracy to flourish, the people of Tamil Nadu have firmly decided that it is possible only under the Hon'ble Chief Minister, Thiru. C. Joseph Vijay, leader of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, a party that stands above caste, religion, language, race and the influence of money, and that holds as its ideological guides Pagutharivu Pagalavan Thanthai Periyar, Perunthalaivar Kamarajar, Satta Medhai Annal Ambedkar, Veeramangai Rani Velu Nachiyar and Makkal Sevagar Anjalai Ammal. With this conviction, the people of Tamil Nadu

have placed the Government led by the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam in power.

4. In keeping with the quote that 'change alone is unchanging', a transformation never seen before in the political history of Tamil Nadu has come about in the recently concluded Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly elections. Within just two years of the party's founding, the historical leader of our times, the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu has formed the Government with the overwhelming support of the people, single-handedly by overcoming many barriers, vanquishing money power and upholding democracy.

5. Perarignar Anna once said, **"Renaissance is not a poison that destroys virtues; it is the means to**

destroy the venomous pests that destroy those virtues.” True to these golden words of Perarignar Anna, the Hon’ble Chief Minister has, in a short time, achieved a feat of Himalayan’s scale by bringing about a new renaissance and a great, widespread Whistle Revolution in the political landscape of Tamil Nadu.

6. Since India attained independence, Perarignar Anna in 1967 and Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. in 1977 ushered in great revolutions in the politics of Tamil Nadu. On similar lines, in 2026, the Hon’ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu has single-handedly brought about a great, historic revolution.

7. This Government will stand as a Government that abides by the core principles

of upholding the State rights, safety and welfare of women, social justice, equal opportunity, welfare of the differently-abled, farmers, fishermen, weavers, labourers, transgender persons and minorities, primacy of education, medicine and healthcare, and inclusive governance that gives proper representation to all while enacting laws, framing schemes and serving the 7.5 crore people of Tamil Nadu.

8. Though the ideological guides of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam — Pagutharivu Pagalavan Thanthai Periyar, Perunthalaivar Kamarajar, Satta Medhai Annal Ambedkar, Rani Velu Nachiyar and Makkal Sevagar Anjalai Ammal — are no longer with us, this Government will safeguard the principles that they propounded and will undertake every

measure necessary to promote the virtues of democracy, following the path of Perarignar Anna and Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R.

9. As the embodiment of coalition government, this Government has demonstrated '**a share in governance and a share in power**' something unseen in the seventy-four-year political history of Tamil Nadu.

10. After the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam Government assumed office, the Hon'ble Chief Minister, Thiru. C. Joseph Vijay, met the Hon'ble Prime Minister of India, Thiru. Narendra Modi, in person at New Delhi. He submitted a memorandum containing several long-standing demands of Tamil Nadu including the establishment of the Centre for Air Borne Systems (CABS) near

Hosur, halting Government of Karnataka's attempt to build the Mekedatu dam, preventing the arrest of Tamil Nadu fishermen by the Government of Sri Lanka and immediate release of fishermen and their boats — and has requested that all necessary assistance, including financial assistance be extended to Tamil Nadu.

11. The Hon'ble Chief Minister has also made various requests to the Union Government regarding fund allocation for highways and infrastructure development in Tamil Nadu, establishment of educational Institutions of National Importance in Tamil Nadu, and administrative sanction for Metro Rail projects needed for the cities of Hosur, Coimbatore and Madurai. In the 11th Governing Council meeting of

NITI Aayog, the Hon'ble Chief Minister once again urged the Union Government to meet these demands. It is sincerely hoped that the Union Government will consider these demands favourably and extend the necessary assistance to Tamil Nadu.

12. A resolution will be passed in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly demanding Tamil Nadu's due share of financial devolution from the taxes contributed to the Union Government. Besides passing the resolution, a Special Legal Committee will be constituted to legally pursue the issue up to the Supreme Court, in order to secure fair financial devolution. Every rupee due to Tamil Nadu will be properly documented and a report detailing the Union Government's

discriminatory approach toward the financial devolution for Tamil Nadu will be published. Further, it will be ensured that Tamil Nadu receives its rightful share of financial devolution from the Union Government.

13. This Government will work diligently to continuously press the Union Government to safeguard the welfare of Tamil Nadu, to fight for State rights, to implement required schemes for the State and to create new infrastructure.

14. Over the past few years, Tamil Nadu's financial position has faced a very severe deterioration. As promised by Hon'ble Chief Minister in his first public address after assuming office, this Government has released a White Paper on Tamil Nadu's

finances to bring out the truth of the previous Government's fiscal mismanagement. In the last five years alone, the debt has nearly doubled, reaching the level of Rs.10 lakh crore; this currently amounts to 28.3 per cent of the Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP). As a result, every individual living in Tamil Nadu bears a debt burden of more than one lakh rupees.

15. The State's revenue deficit which was Rs.48,840 crore in 2024-25 has risen to Rs.78,324 crore in 2025-26 in just one year, amounting to 2.2 per cent of the Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP). Nearly 23 per cent of total revenue receipts is spent on interest payments alone. Owing to revenue leakages and systematic corruption in the revenue and tax-collecting departments, tax revenue has

declined from 5.93 per cent of GSDP in the financial year 2021-22 to 5.45 per cent in 2025-26.

16. This Government has already begun coordinated measures to bring the diverted revenue that rightfully belongs to the Government into the State treasury. In order to bring the revenue that was diverted earlier back into the Government's account, this Government has recently levied an additional privilege fee on liquor manufacturers. Through this, revenues that were escaping credit to State exchequer have been regulated and channelized directly into the State's exchequer, and the Government is expecting receipt of upto one thousand crore rupees annually. This Government is taking every measure to prevent all leakages in revenue

receipts, as well as leakages in Government works and other Government expenditure, and to restore the State's finances on to a sound path which will enable this Government to fully honour the promises it has made to the people of Tamil Nadu.

17. Even though the Government of Tamil Nadu is facing a challenging fiscal situation, the Hon'ble Chief Minister, determined to fulfil the promises made to the people, immediately upon assuming office, issued his first three orders namely: to reduce consumers' electricity charges by providing 200 units of free electricity to households consuming up to 500 units bi-monthly at a cost of Rs.1,730 crore to the Government; to set up a special drug-prevention force in every district across the State; and to

establish the '**Singappen Special Task Force**' for the safety of women and children.

18. The foremost ideal of this Government is to preserve public peace, to uphold the rule of law, to curb crimes against women with an iron hand, and to create a safe environment for women and children. This Government will take very stringent, firm and swift action against those indulging in sexual violence against women and anti-social activities and will secure for them the maximum punishment under the relevant provisions of law. The '**Singappen Special Task Force**', created for ensuring safety of women and children by sanctioning 2,545 new posts, 319 four-wheeler patrol vehicles, 101 two-wheelers and drones

at financial outlay of Rs.354 crore will perform its assigned tasks in an outstanding manner.

19. Over the past few years, drug culture has taken deep roots in Tamil Nadu. The previous Government took no constructive action to curb it. The primary cause of the breakdown of law and order in Tamil Nadu has been the widespread availability of drugs. This Government will work diligently to create a drug-free Tamil Nadu. To this end, this Government has issued orders for the formation of a **Special Drug-Prevention Force** in every district. This Government is taking every measure necessary to completely eradicate the movement of drugs.

20. As a Government that is deeply concerned with the welfare of the public, this Government has closed 717 retail liquor outlets situated within 500 metres of places of worship, educational institutions and bus stands immediately upon assuming office. Necessary stringent rules will be framed and enforced in order to completely eradicate the movement of illicit liquor, illegal sale of liquor, and to tightly regulate this sector. Through this, malpractices in excise and liquor distribution will be curbed and the socio-economic environment of the State will be restored.

21. There has been large leakage of revenues from mineral resources due to corrupt practices that pervades through the mining sector in Tamil Nadu.

This Government will ensure efficient and environmentally sustainable exploitation of mineral resources in the State. Organised illicit mining and tax evasion is being curbed with iron hand through proper regulation and enforcement to ensure that revenues flow into Government treasury without diversion. Through these efforts, Government is striving to double the revenue from minerals.

22. As soon as this Government assumed office, permission was granted to allow free of cost supply of silt deposited in the lakes and ponds of Tamil Nadu to farmers, potters and individuals for their household use. This will not only help increasing the storage capacity of water bodies but will also help conserve rainwater and groundwater. This scheme

will help increase agricultural productivity by improving the nutritional status of the soil. So far, 18,274 lakes and ponds have been notified under this scheme.

23. To help the farming community, Hon'ble Chief Minister has issued orders for fully waiving crop loans from cooperative societies for farmers with outstanding crop loan amount up to Rs.75,000 and waiving Rs.35,000 for all other farmers. This will benefit 14.43 lakh farmers at an additional expenditure of approximately Rs.6,000 crore to the Government.

24. Revitalising the agricultural sector and improving the livelihood of the farming community is the highest priority for this Government. Beyond the immediate financial assistance and loan waivers granted to

farmers, this Government will act as the prime force in protecting farmers' interests through proper irrigation management, modern agricultural technologies, improvement of cold-storage facilities and ensuring remunerative prices for their produce.

25. This Government is firmly committed to rooting out the corruption rampant in the administrative system and to provide the people an honest, transparent and clean administration. Accordingly, all departmental procurements and public tenders will be transparent and will be brought under stringent monitoring mechanisms. Interference of middlemen and illegal gratification practices that prevailed hitherto will be completely eliminated.

26. It is a fundamental policy of this Government that true social justice lies in every community getting due representation. To fulfil this policy and promise, we will urge the Union Government to swiftly complete the caste enumeration in conjunction with the ongoing Population Census. After the Union Government completes the caste enumeration, the Government of Tamil Nadu will conduct the Social Justice Survey.

27. In 1968, when Perarignar Anna was the Chief Minister, a resolution was passed in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly that **“the three-language formula must be removed and only two languages, Tamil and English, should be taught”**. From then until now, two-language policy

has been adopted in Tamil Nadu. This Government will continue to follow this policy since the two-language policy is one that the people of Tamil Nadu have accepted.

28. This Government will urge the Union Government to use Tamil as the language of pleading in the Madras High Court and its Madurai Bench and to establish a Bench of the Supreme Court in Chennai.

29. This Government will strongly oppose the National Education Policy, 2020. The Union Government's stand that the amount of Rs.3,458 crore due to Tamil Nadu under the '**Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan**' will be released only if the three-language formula under the National Education Policy is implemented is unacceptable. This is

tantamount to imposing the three-language formula on Tamil Nadu. This Government will urge the Union Government to reconsider its stand linking the implementation of three-language formula with the allocation of funds and to immediately release the funds due to Tamil Nadu.

30. Issues such as NEET examination, imposition of the National Education Policy and three-language formula have arisen consequent to education being in concurrent list of the Constitution. Therefore, this Government will undertake all necessary efforts to move education from the Concurrent List to the State List.

31. True educational reform lies in raising the quality of educational institutions and their teaching skills. Accordingly, this

Government will act on a war footing to fill up the necessary posts of Assistant Professors and teaching staff that have been lying vacant for a long time in State's universities and higher-education institutions in a transparent manner strictly based on eligibility and merit. Moreover, this Government will introduce various fundamental reforms in the higher-education sector. Through this, the students of Tamil Nadu will get world class education.

32. The Cauvery delta region is the granary of Tamil Nadu. The farmers of this region depend on Cauvery water as the main water source of the delta districts. Tamil Nadu has the right to use Cauvery water from time immemorial. Even after our right was upheld in the Supreme Court, we are having to

struggle every year to obtain Cauvery water. Instead of giving our due share of water, only surplus water is being released to Tamil Nadu by the Government of Karnataka. In this situation, the Government of Karnataka is attempting to implement the Mekedatu project. If this project is implemented, agricultural production as well as farmers livelihood will be severely affected. This Government is taking necessary legal measures to halt this and to get water for Tamil Nadu at the right time.

33. The fishermen of Tamil Nadu continue to face numerous challenges that affect their livelihood and economic security. In addition to the adverse impacts of monsoons, cyclones and other natural disasters, fishermen fishing in the Palk Bay frequently encounter serious

hardships while fishing in their traditional waters. They are often apprehended by the Sri Lankan naval authorities and their fishing boats are seized and impounded and substantial penalties are imposed upon them. While this Government will continue to urge the Union Government to secure a resolution to this long-standing issue, it will at the same time, undertake various measures to strengthen livelihood of fishermen.

34. This Government will act firmly to mitigate climate change, to increase Tamil Nadu's forest cover and green cover and to protect all vital ecosystems including mangrove forests, wetlands and the coastal ecosystem.

35. A programme for maintenance of lakes and ponds will be implemented every year to

help raise groundwater level and to conserve water during rainy seasons. Further, measures will be undertaken to build check dams at appropriate locations in order to prevent water flowing out to the sea and to conserve rainwater.

36. The Mullai Periyar dam is the lifeline of people of the southern districts. In 2014, the Supreme Court ordered that the water level of the Mullai Periyar dam may be raised to 142 feet and also advised that its water level may be raised further to 152 feet after strengthening the dam. However, the Government of Kerala, while continuing to refuse permission to carry out strengthening works of the dam, has instead been pressing its demand for building a new dam. This Government will take firm

measures to prevent the Government of Kerala's attempt to build a new dam and will take concerted action to carry out repair works in the Mullai Periyar dam area and raise the water level of the dam.

37. This Government will make intensive efforts to implement the river-interlinking project, first to interlink the rivers within Tamil Nadu and further to urge the Union Government to interlink the rivers of the southern States.

38. This Government will arrange continued archaeological research at the sites of Keezhadi, Adichanallur, Kodumanal, Mayiladumparai, Sivakalai, Azhagankulam, Arikamedu, Saluvankuppam and Poompuhar; strive to obtain UNESCO World Heritage Site recognition for the two sites of

Keezhadi and Adichanallur; and arrange for school students to be taken on educational tours to these sites. Further, at the cultural sites of Adichanallur, Kodumanal and Gangaikonda Cholapuram, the experience of Tamil civilisation will be recreated for tourists through Augmented Reality and Virtual Reality (AR/VR) technologies. Alongside this, a comprehensive '**Sustainable Tourism Policy**' will be framed so as to preserve the State's natural resources and ecological balance. By developing environmentally sustainable infrastructure, this Government will transform Tamil Nadu into a global destination for heritage and eco-tourism.

39. This Government is firm that industries must grow and workers must thrive in order to achieve the target set by the Hon'ble

Chief Minister to transform Tamil Nadu to a 1.5 trillion dollar economy by 2036. The procedures for starting industrial enterprises will be simplified to boost industrial growth in Tamil Nadu. This Government will also take measures for early grant of permissions needed to start Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) through a single-window system. Through these measures, Tamil Nadu will achieve rapid industrial growth and lakhs of employment opportunities will be created.

40. With the aim of promoting the State's economic stability and industrial growth, while maintaining continuity with the previous industrial policies, this Government will notify a new industrial policy that considers the present and future requirements and offers special incentive schemes for domestic and

global companies to make fresh investments in Tamil Nadu. This Government will enhance the '**Ease of Doing Business**' environment by upgrading the Single Window System into a fully digital platform applicable to all sectors and granting all permissions swiftly without any administrative delay.

41. A '**Tamil Nadu Investor Promotion Commission**' will be established under the chairmanship of the Chief Secretary with a view to attracting the investments of multinational companies. Through this Commission, measures will be taken to grant fast track permissions to start operations to companies investing more than Rs.200 crore or providing employment to 5,000 persons.

42. Creating a poverty-free Tamil Nadu is the foremost goal of this Government.

To completely eradicate poverty, this Government will identify poor families in Tamil Nadu and ensure that Government's welfare schemes reach them, improve their livelihood by creating opportunities and facilities for them to undertake self-employment.

43. Tamil Nadu is the most urbanised State in India. By 2031, Tamil Nadu will stand as India's model State for urban excellence. Over the next five years, every Municipal Corporation, Municipality and Town Panchayat in Tamil Nadu will provide better quality life to its citizens by providing clean drinking-water supply, modern urban infrastructure, green and clean environment, digital governance and stable economic opportunities.

44. Examinations will be conducted through the recruitment boards in a time bound and transparent manner to fill the vacancies in Government departments and appointments will be made strictly following due process. Through this, dream of a thousands of youth for government jobs will come true.

45. Recognising the need for giving special attention to Artificial Intelligence (AI), this Government has expanded the scope of the Information Technology and Digital Services Department to include Artificial Intelligence. This department will facilitate the use of Artificial Intelligence tools to improve the efficiency of Government departments and to provide better e-governance services to the public.

46. The Government of Tamil Nadu is firm in protecting social justice and is undertaking every effort to safeguard Tamil Nadu's 69 per cent reservation. Moreover, standing as a bulwark for minorities, this Government will always support the advancement of minorities and will always uphold their rights. I am confident that this Government will stand tall as a truly '**Secular, Social-Justice**' Government.

47. By providing high-quality school education, higher education in the world's finest universities, employment and self-employment opportunities, housing and infrastructure facilities, skill development, and economic and livelihood advancement, this Government will stand as

a Government that upholds the Social Justice for Adi Dravidar and Tribal people.

48. This Government is resolved to protect the welfare of the differently-abled. Tamil Nadu will stand as a leading State in ensuring the rights, equality and social security of the differently-abled. In addition to providing equal access to digital and physical infrastructure for the differently-abled, special attention will also be given for their advancement in society. This Government will also take measures to implement the 4 per cent reservation for the differently-abled in letter and spirit.

49. This Government will work towards establishing **Olympic Centres of Excellence** with a clear vision of producing future Olympic medal winners and positioning Tamil Nadu as

India's foremost sporting power house. These world-class centres will offer athletes the finest in training infrastructure, elite coaching, cutting-edge sports science, performance analytics and comprehensive athlete development.

50. To enable transgender persons to live with dignity, this Government will support them by providing skill development training, forming self-help groups, facilitating in finding employment and livelihood opportunities and aiding in creating housing facilities.

51. To improve administration of our historic spiritual temples, this Government will carry out structural reforms in the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Department. Measures will be taken to fully audit all temple properties, lands and

endowment revenues and to introduce transparent computerised accounts. Administrative malpractices that prevailed in earlier times will be completely eliminated and this Government will ensure that all movable and immovable assets of the temples are used solely for their sacred purposes.

52. Government employees play a key role in delivering Government's welfare schemes to the people. Teachers play a key role in guiding the younger generation along the right path. The welfare of Government employees, teachers and pensioners will be continuously protected and the health insurance schemes for them will be further improved.

53. To further promote the development of Tamil Nadu and to improve the livelihood of

people, this Government will implement an all-encompassing '**Vetri Thamizhagam – Vision Document**' over the next five years. This developmental path comprises of ten pillars; namely 1) Tamil identity and pride, 2) dignified living and social security, 3) welfare of women, 4) welfare of youth, 5) welfare of farmers, agricultural labourers and fishermen, 6) world-class education, 7) a prosperous Tamil Nadu, 8) excellent healthcare and environment, 9) world-class infrastructure and 10) a people's welfare Government and a good and transparent administration.

54. This Government is resolved to break through every obstacle to deliver a corruption-free and honest administration and thereby to bring about an economic revival.

This Government will strive to ensure that its welfare schemes reach all sections of people. All the promises announced by this Government will be fulfilled one by one in the years to come by streamlining the State's financial position.

55. Amid great expectations, the people of Tamil Nadu have chosen this Government led by the Hon'ble Chief Minister Thiru. C. Joseph Vijay by overcoming money power, muscle power and the power of authority. It is the duty of this Government to fulfil the people's expectations. I trust that you, the Members of the Legislative Assembly, will extend your cooperation to this Government in fulfilling this duty. I have no doubt that you will take part in the debates

held in this House and offer constructive suggestions to the Government.

56. In keeping with Valluvar's words, "**Pirappokkum Ella Uyirkkum**" (all lives are equal by birth), this Government will function as a Government for all and a Government for the people — honestly, transparently and with full openness, free of favour or prejudice.

57. Let us make Tamil Nadu the foremost State in India. Let us strive for Tamil Nadu to stand as a model for other States. I conclude my address by requesting all of you, Members of the Legislative Assembly, to extend your full cooperation to the efforts of the Government.

Nanri, Vanakkam.
